

## One-Night Stand

# Andy Out-Maneuvered Master-Mover Dressen

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PHILADELPHIA — If you're 40 or better and didn't squander your youth on such nonsense as school books and laboratory research, the resolution of the Phillies' home opener here Thursday night undoubtedly stirred you beyond words.

Andy Cohen, manager of the chronic cellar-dwellers for one game, opened and closed with a victory. He beat the powerful Braves, out-maneuvering that master-mover, Chuck Dressen, as though it was something to be done every night in the week instead of once in a career of almost 40 years.

Back in the days when John McGraw thought he finally had the box-office lure for Jewish customers in the chunky little Texas second baseman, Andy bidded it up with a gargantuan giant catcher named Shanty Hogan. Hogan weighed more than 250 and wasn't satisfied. He literally ate his way out of the big leagues, using such subterfuges as writing "spinach" on a dining-room cloth and sitting back to await the conniving waiter with a double eclair.

THERE WERENT any TV shaving commercials in the late '20s but there was a demand for ball players who could sing a little and wouldn't blow a punch line. So Cohen and Hogan hooked up with a sings - and - snappy - patter vaudeville routine that did all right to the tune of \$1,500 a week, post-season. It was Cohen and Hogan all over the Keith circuit except in Boston where the names were reversed.

Thursday night the old trouper didn't forget his vaudeville lessons. After the 10 - inning triumph, where he juggled left-handed, right - handed situations just like a Stengel, Andy Cohen gave it the old Dixie finish and left the customers, 32,000 of them, smiling. They almost forgot, in that brief moment of local glory, the only reason for Andy running the show alternately from the first-base coaching box and the bench. It was because Gene Mauch, replacement for Eddie Sawyer, wouldn't get here from Florida until Friday.

"Look at me," moaned Andy before the game, "all my life I wanted to manage in the majors, and now I'm hired and fired on the same night." That he was, except he goes out with a 1,000 record matched only by Brooklyn's Clyde Sukeforth.

SUKEY WAS projected into the managerial role for the first two games of the 1947 campaign because Happy Chandler gave Leo Durocher the hook for the season and Branch Rickey had trouble locating Barney Shotton scouting somewhere in the boondocks.

No other unbeaten managers come to mind and certainly, if McGraw didn't get his Jewish box office star for the Polo Grounds back in the late '20s, he was instrumental in giving the Phillies their first, and presumably last, unbeaten manager.

Mauch is reportedly all enthusiasm over taking over a club which blew 50 decisions last year. He'll be the fifth Philly manager in nine years, a dubious arrangement of figures which dictate (A) home rentals only and (B) use of quick-service laundries only.



Andy Cohen . . . goes out with 1,000 mark

## Ol' Sad Sam Should Have Known Better

SAN FRANCISCO (AP)—Sam Jones, ace of the San Francisco pitching staff, escorted Ernie Banks through the new, spacious Giant dressing room at Candlestick Park. When the Chicago shortstop departed, Jones commented:

"That guy won't hit any homers around here."

Jones should have known better. Banks, Most Valuable Player in the National League for two years, belted a grand slammer in the fourth inning as the Cubs beat the Giants 6-5 Thursday night.

It was the second night in a row a Banks homer helped the Cubs win. The first came at Los Angeles.

The Chicagoans, in pre-season were lightly rated, but now feel themselves a much improved outfit.

"We'll surprise a few pessimists," said reliever Don Elston. "I think we'll finish in the first division."

"We've got Banks and he's good for 150 runs batted in to start with."

The Cubs have a new manager, Charley Grimm, who first joined the team in 1924 and has been its field boss three times.

He feels several trades made the club better balanced and more solid.

Frank Thomas, a terror at the plate two years ago, and Richie Ashburn were the key men obtained in pre-season swaps.

Thomas had three hits against the Giants and a three run homer the night before in Los Angeles. He's playing left field where he wants to be instead of third base, his post the last few years at Pittsburgh and Cincinnati.

Grimm feels George Altman, a 6-4 first baseman, will erase Cub problems there. Altman, in only his second year in the majors, fields well and has power.

Ashburn, though slowing up a bit at 33, can still get on base. He doubled and walked against the Giants, and has six hits in 13 at-bats this season.

And, of course, there's Banks . . . the only shortstop ever to hit more than 40 home runs in a season. He's done it four times.



Sam Jones



Ernie Banks